Summary of paper 01: tables and figures of the extended data-generating process

pmsimstats team

October 28, 2026

Problem and approach

Validating a predictive biomarker requires an interaction test, which needs about four times the sample of a main-effect test. Hendrickson et al. (2020) proposed a data-generating process (DGP) for simulating aggregated N-of-1 trials. In that original DGP the predictive biomarker is a correlation with the drug response that is present on drug and absent off drug. Paper 01 extends the original DGP for the Hybrid design with carryover. It judges each extension by five criteria: existence, identifiability under carryover, fidelity to the pharmacology, analyzability and calibration status. This summary reproduces every table and figure of the paper in the paper's order.

Methods

Table 1 states which analysis targets which quantity. The paired-difference statistic E9 is the one with a closed form.

Table 1: The analyses used in this paper and the quantity each estimates.

Analysis	Drug indicator	Estimates	Used in
Paired-difference statistic E9, E9b (closed form)	binary	on-minus-off contrast, $\beta_{bm:D}$ times the on/off correlation difference	Stages 1, 2, 4, 5; planning

Analysis	Drug indicator	Estimates	Used in
The original analysis (mixed model)	binary	the same contrast	Stage 2 (original code)
Stress-test analyses	$D_{bc,it}$ at the true half-life	on-drug moderation $\beta_{bm:D}$	Stage 6

Table 2 lays out three simulation studies. They verify the closed forms, rerun the original code and stress-test fourteen analyses under a prognostic biomarker.

Table 2: Design of the three simulation studies in the ADEMP structure. MCSE: Monte Carlo standard error of a rejection rate, $\sqrt{p(1-p)/R}$ for R replicates.

	1. Closed-form verification	2. The original code	3. Stress test under a prognostic biomarker
Aim	Check the closed-form moments and power of Appendix A, and the loss of power under the original rule	Show on the original code that the correlation rule alone determines the loss of power	Find which analyses keep their nominal size under features the extended DGP adds

	1. Closed-form verification	2. The original code	3. Stress test under a prognostic biomarker
Data-generating mechanisms	The correlation encoding with the original rule and with the decaying correlation; compound symmetry and the separable AR(1) form; carryover on the drug-response mean decaying from the last on-drug value; Hybrid, crossover and OL+BDC designs; $N = 70$; grids of c_{bm} and $t_{1/2}$	The original `generateData()` at commit 58b32a9, as published and with the decaying correlation only (Appendix B.1); $c_{bm} = 0.25$. (a) Hybrid, $N = 70$, no censoring, $t_{1/2} \in \{0, 0.1, 0.2, 1\}$; (b) four designs, $N \in \{35, 70\}$, $t_{1/2} \in \{0, 0.1, 0.2\}$, the original censoring patterns	The extended DGP (Table 11) with fixed allocation; base cell separable AR(1), $\rho = 0.7$, $N = 70$, $t_{1/2} = 0.5$ week; 15 null cells (11 without and 4 with a prognostic pathway of strength 0.3) and 10 alternative cells at $c_{bm} = 0.30$ varying N, half-life, decay form, dropout and measurement error
Estimand	$\beta_{bm:D}$, and the mean of the paired-difference statistic	$\beta_{bm:D}$	$\beta_{bm:D}$
Methods	Paired-difference statistics E9 and E9b, closed form and simulated; the original mixed model fitted with `lmer`	The original analysis pipeline (`lmer`, model-based test) on both versions	Fourteen analyses fitted to the same simulated trials; two-sided tests at $\alpha = 0.05$
Performance measures	Mean, SD and power of the statistic; agreement as (simulated − closed form)/MCSE	Power; mean interaction estimate; number of repaired correlation matrices	Null rejection rate; power; κ, the ratio of mean model SE to empirical SD; failed fits

Replicates	5,000 per cell (MCSE of power at most 0.007); 500 to 1,000 for `lmer`	(a) 500 per cell (MCSE at most 0.022); (b) 250 per cell (at most 0.032)	1,000 per null cell (MCSE 0.0069 at a rate of 0.05), 500 per alternative cell (at most 0.022)

Results

Stage 1. Validity of the joint distribution

Table 3 counts correlation matrices that are not positive definite. The original code repaired 20 matrices (25%) on its own grid without a warning. The extended DGP stops instead, and it finds 75% of the grid infeasible at $c_{bm} = 0.6$.

Table 3: Correlation matrices that are not positive definite. Figure 4 grid: open label, open label plus blinded discontinuation, crossover and Hybrid designs; $t_{1/2} \in \{0, 0.1, 0.2\}$ week. Extended grid: the last three designs; $t_{1/2} \in \{0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.5, 1\}$ week. The original-DGP counts reproduce those of the original code exactly. The extended-DGP counts are the same at $\rho = 0.7$ (the recommended value) and $\rho = 0.8$ because both feasibility bounds lie between 0.3 and 0.6.

Grid (number of matrices)	Original DGP (constant correlation, compound symmetry, $\rho_{cs} = 0.8$)	Extended DGP (decaying correlation, separable AR(1)), $\rho = 0.8$	Extended DGP, $\rho = 0.7$
Figure 4 grid of the original study, $c_{bm} \in \{0, 0.3, 0.6\}$ (81)	20 (25%)	21 (26%)	21 (26%)
Extended grid, $c_{bm} = 0.25$ (40)	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	0 (0%)
Extended grid, $c_{bm} = 0.3$ (40)	12 (30%)	0 (0%)	0 (0%)
Extended grid, $c_{bm} = 0.6$ (40)	12 (30%)	30 (75%)	30 (75%)

Stage 2. The biomarker-response correlation under carryover

Table 4 gives closed-form power by half-life. Under the original rule E9 power is 0.050 at every positive half-life. Under the decaying rule it is 0.721 at 0.1 week and falls to 0.278 at 2 weeks.

Table 4: Closed-form power by carryover half-life (weeks). Hybrid design, $N = 70$, $c_{bm} = 0.25$, compound symmetry. Constant: the original rule (constant correlation after first exposure). Decaying: the extended rule (correlation decaying at the carryover half-life). E9: paired-difference statistic on post-baseline visits; E9b: the same with baseline counted as an off-drug visit, as in the original analysis. Against Monte Carlo estimates (5,000 replicates per cell), 10 of 278 cell-variants differ by more than 2 Monte Carlo SE.

Correlation rule	Statistic	0	0.1	0.2	0.5	1	2
Constant (original)	E9	0.721	0.050	0.050	0.050	0.050	0.050
	E9b	0.654	0.081	0.081	0.081	0.081	0.081
Decaying	E9	0.721	0.721	0.712	0.631	0.473	0.278
	E9b	0.654	0.653	0.647	0.586	0.472	0.327

Figure 1 shows the same result as lines, with Monte Carlo points on them. The original rule drops to a flat floor and the decaying rule declines smoothly.

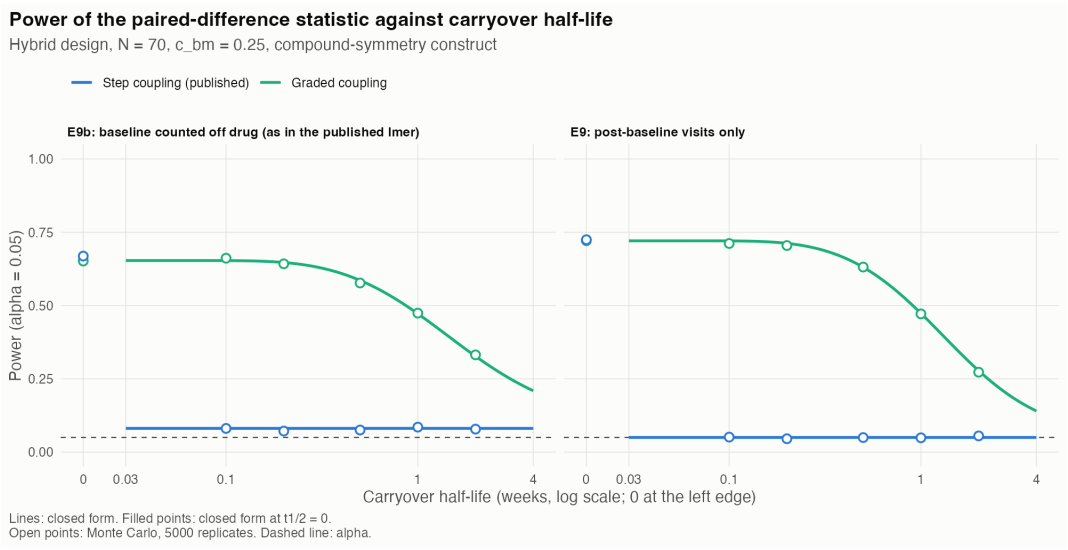


Figure 1: Closed-form power (lines) against carryover half-life, with Monte Carlo estimates (points; 5,000 replicates per cell), under the original rule (constant correlation after first exposure) and the extended rule (correlation decaying at the carryover half-life). Hybrid design, $N = 70$, $c_{bm} = 0.25$, compound symmetry; left panel E9b, right panel E9.

Figure 2 plots power against the on/off correlation difference. Power depends on the correlation

rule only through this difference.

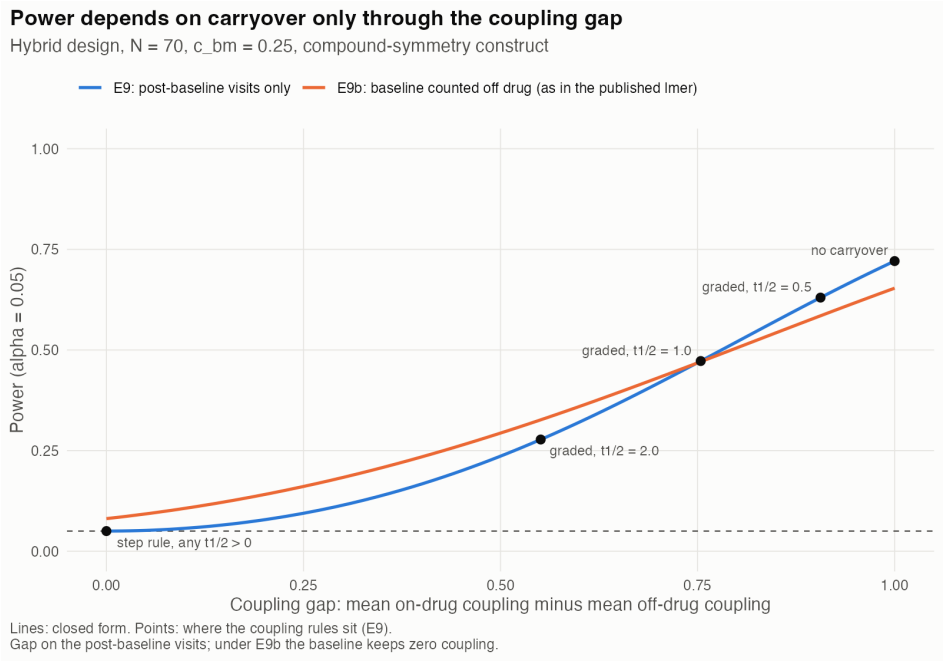


Figure 2: Closed-form power against the on/off correlation difference, with the positions of the two correlation rules. Hybrid design, $N = 70$, $c_{bm} = 0.25$, E9.

Table 5 repeats the comparison in the original code, with only the correlation lines replaced. At 0.1 week power is 0.126 with the original rule and 0.638 with the decaying rule, against 0.668 without carryover.

Table 5: The original code at commit 58b32a9, as published (original) and with the decaying correlation (decaying): Hybrid design, $N = 70$, $c_{bm} = 0.25$, 500 replicates per cell, same seeds. Monte Carlo SE of power at most 0.022.

$t_{1/2}$ (weeks)	Mean estimate, original	Mean estimate, decaying	Power, original	Power, decaying
0	-0.131	-0.131	0.668	0.668
0.1	-0.028	-0.129	0.126	0.638
0.2	-0.029	-0.131	0.092	0.656
1	-0.033	-0.107	0.094	0.462

Figure 3 repeats the comparison for all four designs, both sample sizes and five censoring patterns. The decaying correlation keeps power where the original rule loses it.

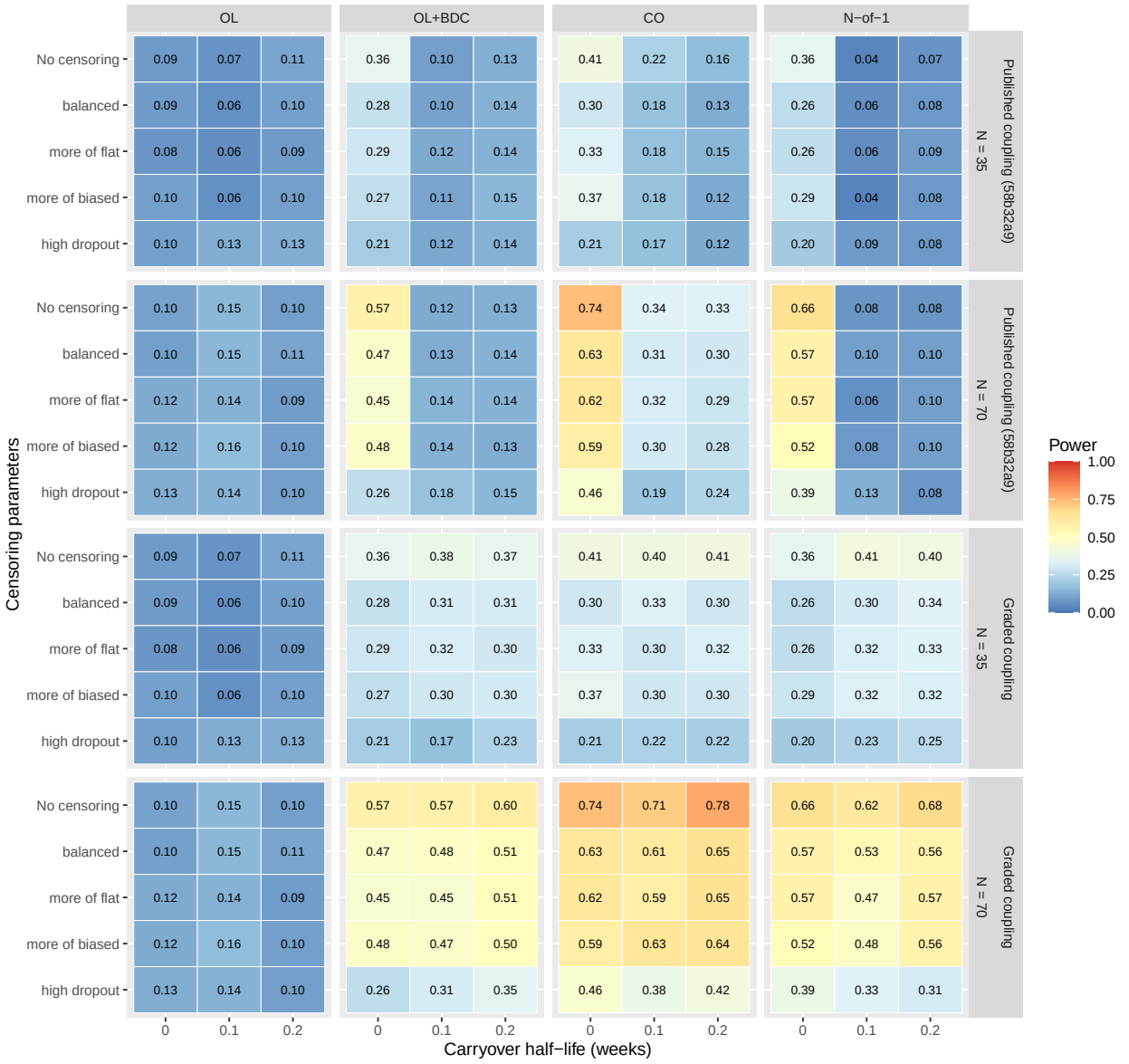


Figure 3: Power to detect the biomarker-by-treatment interaction, in the layout of Figure 4B of the original study, from the original code at commit 58b32a9 as published (upper two panel rows) and with the decaying correlation (lower two panel rows). Rows within panels: censoring patterns; columns: carryover half-life; panels: trial design (N-of-1 is the Hybrid design) and total sample size. $c_{bm} = 0.25$, 250 replicates per cell (Monte Carlo SE at most 0.032), the same seeds for both versions. No matrix was repaired in either version.

Figure 4 extends the comparison over interaction strengths and longer half-lives. Gray cells mark effect sizes with no valid joint distribution.

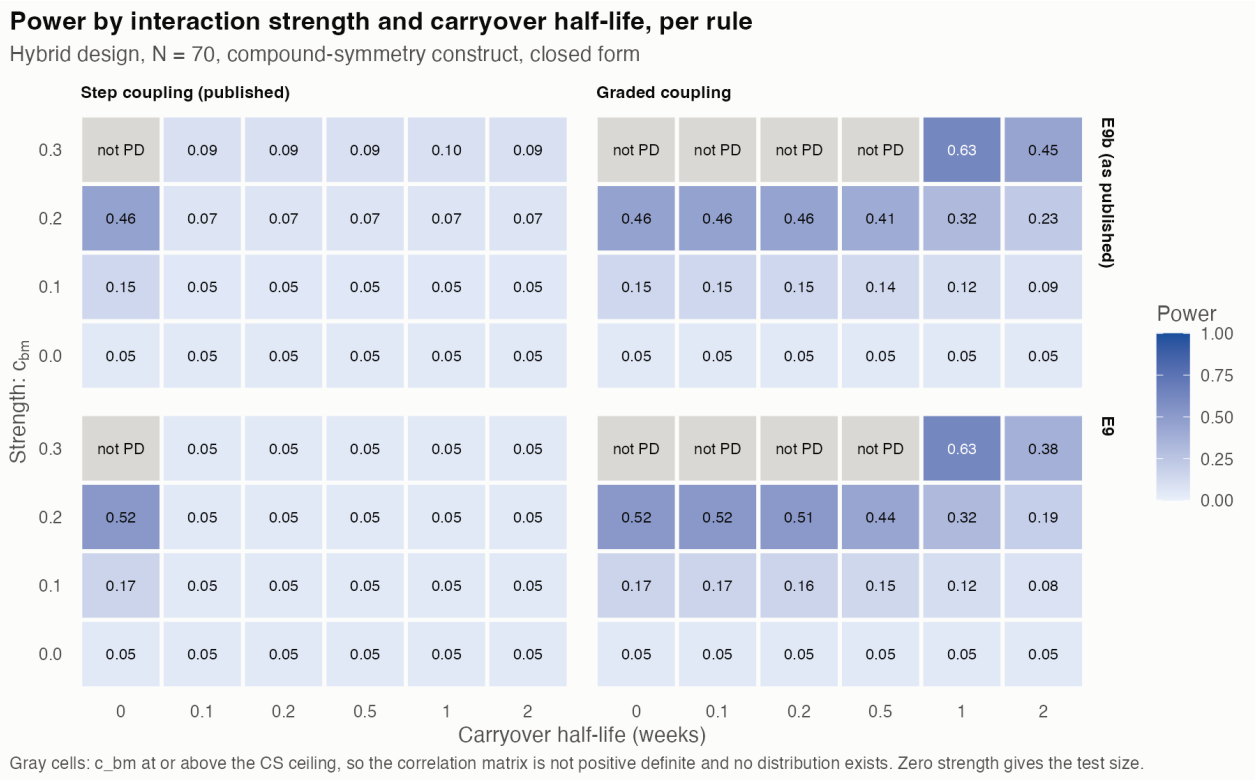


Figure 4: Closed-form power of the paired-difference statistic by interaction strength (c_{bm}) and carryover half-life, in the layout of Figure 4B of the original study: the original rule (labeled Step in the figure) and the decaying correlation (labeled Graded). Upper row: E9b, which counts baseline as an off-drug visit as the original analysis does; lower row: E9. Gray cells: c_{bm} at or above the compound-symmetry feasibility bound, where the correlation matrix is not positive definite. Hybrid design, $N = 70$, compound symmetry.

Stage 3. Carryover on the mean

Figure 5 shows the drug-response mean by visit for the four Hybrid paths under both carryover rules. The two rules differ only in the path means.

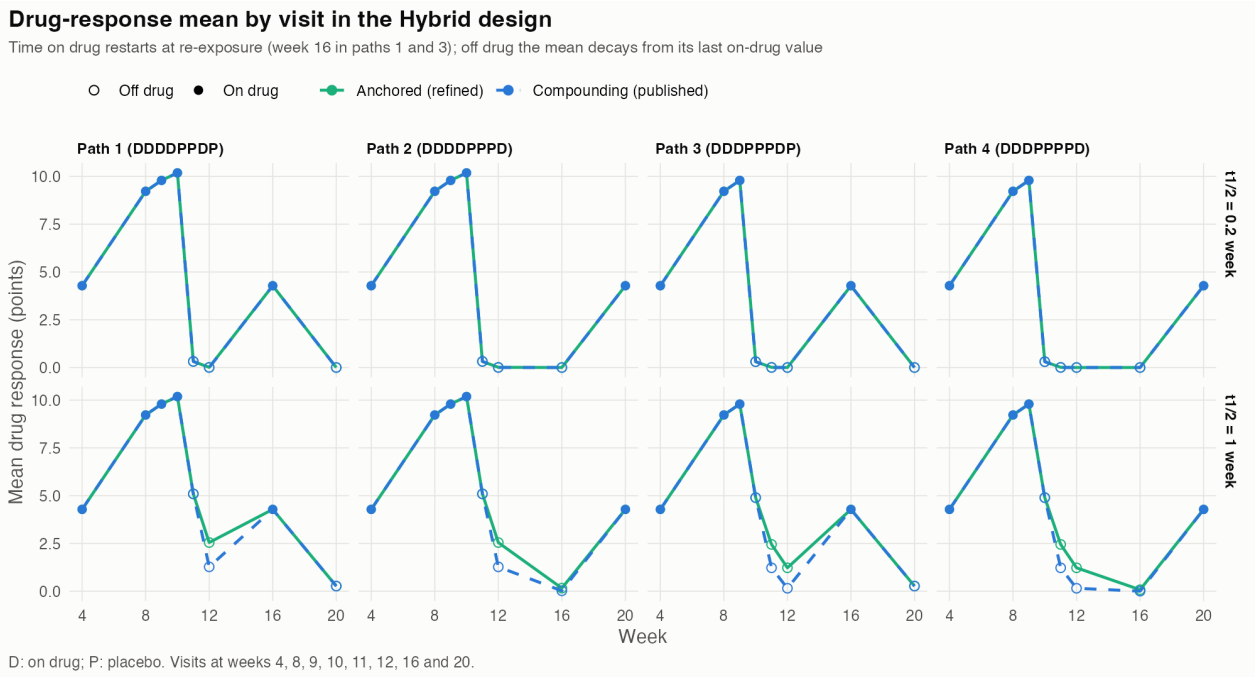


Figure 5: Drug-response mean by visit in the Hybrid design, by path, under the extended carryover rule (decay from the last on-drug mean, the extended DGP) and the original carryover rule (compounded decay), at carryover half-lives of 0.2 and 1 week. Filled points: on-drug visits; open points: off-drug visits. D: drug; P: placebo.

Stage 4. Serial correlation

Table 6 shows what the serial correlation does. Under compound symmetry, lowering ρ_{cs} from 0.8 to 0.7 raises the feasibility bound from 0.256 to 0.346. It lowers power at $c_{bm} = 0.25$ from 0.721 to 0.628.

Table 6: Serial correlation: the feasibility bound on c_{bm} (Ceiling; decaying correlation, no carryover, minimum over the Hybrid, crossover and OL+BDC designs) and closed-form E9 power (Hybrid, $N = 70$, no carryover) by ρ, under compound symmetry and under the separable AR(1) form of Stage 5. Under compound symmetry the Hybrid and crossover designs tie for the minimum. Under the separable form the minimum is attained in the Hybrid design at $\rho = 0.8$ and in the OL+BDC design at $\rho \leq 0.7$, and the crossover design is never binding. At $t_{1/2} = 0.2$ week every power value is lower by 0.004 to 0.009.

	Compound symmetry		Separable AR(1)	
ρ_{cs} or ρ	Ceiling	Power at $c_{bm} = 0.25$	Ceiling	Power at $c_{bm} = 0.25$
0.5	0.458	0.492	0.448	0.261
0.6	0.410	0.553	0.462	0.270
0.7	0.346	0.628	0.474	0.290
0.8	0.256	0.721	0.440	0.335

Stage 5. Cross-component structure

Table 7 compares three correlation structures. At $\rho = 0.7$ the separable AR(1) structure allows a correlation of 0.474, against 0.346 under compound symmetry.

Table 7: Largest feasible biomarker-response correlation c_{bm} under the decaying correlation, without carryover, minimum over the Hybrid, crossover and OL+BDC designs. Under compound symmetry the Hybrid and crossover designs tie for the minimum. Under the two AR(1) forms the minimum is attained in the Hybrid design at $\rho = 0.8$ and in the OL+BDC design at $\rho = 0.7$ (separable form: Hybrid 0.480), and the crossover design is never binding.

ρ_{cs} or ρ	Compound symmetry	AR(1), two-constant cross-component	Separable AR(1)
0.8	0.256	0.291	0.440
0.7	0.346	0.452	0.474

Stage 6. Features the extended DGP adds

Table 8 gives null rejection rates under a prognostic biomarker. The original analysis rejected 0.159 under the placebo-response pathway. The expectancy-term model stayed between 0.040 and 0.047.

Table 8: Null rejection rates under a prognostic biomarker, 1,000 replicates per cell (two-MCSE band 0.036 to 0.064 for a single cell), first run of study 3 (original carryover rule for the mean, fixed allocation). The rerun with carryover decaying from the last on-drug mean changed no analysis's verdict. Rates above 0.075 in bold.

Analysis	Natural history, constant	Natural history, growing	Placebo response	Baseline severity
Original analysis (random intercept, model-based)	**0.107**	0.053	**0.159**	0.075
Random intercept + CAR(1), CR2	**0.099**	0.049	**0.100**	0.050
The same, half-life chosen by AIC	**0.115**	0.058	**0.112**	0.055
Unstructured covariance, Kenward-Roger	**0.416**	**0.195**	**0.222**	0.051
The same, half-life chosen by AIC	**0.509**	**0.245**	**0.256**	0.064
Random intercept + CAR(1) with expectancy terms, CR2	0.047	0.046	0.040	0.040
The same, with phase-specific residual variances, CR2	0.055	0.044	0.042	0.042
The same, with phase-specific residual variances, model-based	0.062	0.043	0.045	0.046
Expectancy terms, half-life chosen by AIC, CR2	0.059	0.052	0.047	0.045
Random intercept + CAR(1) with free baseline slope, CR2	0.049	0.063	0.049	0.050

Table 9 gives the feasibility bounds when a prognostic correlation shares the biomarker row with c_{bm}. Each correlation lowers the room left for the other.

Table 9: Largest feasible prognostic correlation given the biomarker-response correlation, and the reverse, under the extended DGP (separable AR(1), $\rho = 0.7$, $c_1 = 0.2$), Hybrid design, minimum over its four paths. Correlation: the quantity whose bound is given. c_{PB}, c_{TV}, c_{BL}: correlation of the biomarker with the placebo-response component, the natural-history component and baseline severity. None: no value is feasible.

Correlation	Given	$t_{1/2} = 0.2$ week	$t_{1/2} = 0.5$ week
c_{PB} or c_{TV}	alone	0.513	0.513
	$c_{bm} = 0.25$	0.466	0.477
	$c_{bm} = 0.30$	0.435	0.451
	$c_{bm} = 0.45$	0.243	0.306
c_{BL}	alone	1.000	1.000
	$c_{bm} = 0.25$	0.857	0.876
	$c_{bm} = 0.30$	0.786	0.815
	$c_{bm} = 0.45$	0.374	0.496
c_{bm}	alone	0.485	0.518
	$c_{PB} = 0.3$	0.422	0.454
	$c_{PB} = 0.6$	none	none

Table 10 shows what each optional feature does to size and power. In the base cell power is 0.476 for the original analysis, 0.508 for the CAR(1) model and 0.410 for the expectancy-term model.

Table 10: The optional features of the extended DGP: null rejection rate ($c_{bm} = 0$; 1,000 replicates, MCSE 0.007) and power ($c_{bm} = 0.30$; 500 replicates, MCSE at most 0.022) for the original analysis (Original), the random-intercept CAR(1) model with CR2 and the expectancy-term model with CR2 (Expect.). Hybrid design, first run of study 3. Each row changes one feature of the base cell.

	Null rejection			Power		
Cell	Original	CAR(1)	Expect.	Original	CAR(1)	Expect.
Base cell ($N = 70$, $t_{1/2} = 0.5$, exponential, no dropout)	0.076	0.049	0.062	0.476	0.508	0.410
Measurement error (SD 3 and 6)	0.071	0.051	0.047	0.424	0.400	0.310
Dropout 20 percent, completely at random	0.079	0.059	0.051	0.460	0.466	0.382
Dropout 20 percent, dependent on last score	0.064	0.056	0.044	0.426	0.436	0.366
Weibull decay, shape 0.5	0.073	0.047	0.046	0.384	0.384	0.298
Weibull decay, shape 2	0.066	0.037	0.045	0.538	0.536	0.476
$t_{1/2} = 0$	0.072	0.036	0.049	0.540	0.538	0.484
$t_{1/2} = 1$ week	0.061	0.043	0.061	0.388	0.384	0.310
$N = 35$	0.081	0.058	0.053	0.270	0.238	0.206
$N = 150$	0.063	0.047	0.047	0.770	0.820	0.726

Stage 7. The extended DGP

Table 11 collects the choices. The Kind column marks each element as an extension, a choice, an option or a retained element.

Table 11: The extended data-generating process. Defaults are those used in the stress test unless stated.

Element	Specification	Default	Kind	Justified in
Components	$Y_{it} = \mathrm{BL}_i - (TV_{it} + PB_{it} + BR_{it})$, Gompertz means as in the original DGP	original parameters	retained	Methods
Validity	stop if the correlation matrix is not positive definite	always	extension	Stage 1

Element	Specification	Default	Kind	Justified in
Biomarker-response correlation	c_{bm} on drug; $c_{bm}2^{-t_{sd}/t_{1/2}}$ off drug after exposure; 0 before exposure	c_{bm} below the feasibility bound of every design in the study	extension	Stage 2
Carryover on the mean	decay from the last on-drug value, $\mu_{BR,\text{last}}\,2^{-t_{sd}/t_{1/2}}$	$t_{1/2} = 0.1$ to 0.2 week (pharmacological, assumed); 0.5 in the stress test	choice	Stage 3
Re-exposure	as in the original DGP: time on drug restarts at zero	on, for titrated drugs	retained	Stage 3
Within-component correlation	AR(1) in weeks, $\rho^{\lvert w_t - w_s \rvert}$, one ρ for all three components	$\rho = 0.7$ (convention; report and vary)	choice	Stage 4
Cross-component correlation	separable, $c_1\rho^{\lvert w_t - w_s \rvert}$ at every lag; the Kronecker form applies to the correlation, since the PB SD scales with the expectancy	$c_1 = 0.2$ (original value)	choice	Stage 5
Path allocation	fixed numbers, as in the original DGP	original values	retained	Methods
Prognostic correlations	correlation of the biomarker with TV or PB, or with baseline severity; or a mean shift of TV growing along its curve	off; 0.3 in the stress test; correlations must lie inside the joint bound with c_{bm} (Table 9)	option	Stage 6

Element	Specification	Default	Kind	Justified in
Measurement error	independent, SD by phase	off; 3 open label, 6 blinded in the stress test	option (driver only)	Stage 6
Decay form	exponential or Weibull with the same half-life	exponential	option	Stage 6
Dropout	monotone, completely at random or at random given the last score	off; 20% in the stress test	option	Stage 6

Using the extended DGP to plan a trial

Table 12 gives the total sample size for 80 percent power. At a half-life of 0.2 week the Hybrid design needs 278 participants at $c_{bm} = 0.25$ and 84 at 0.45. At 1 week it needs 480 and 146.

Table 12: Planning under the extended DGP (separable AR(1), $\rho = 0.7$, $c_1 = 0.2$, decaying correlation, carryover decaying from the last on-drug mean): total N for 80 percent power of the paired-difference statistic E9 at $\alpha = 0.05$, by design, interaction strength and carryover half-life, with the implied slope in symptom points per SD of biomarker ($\sigma_{BR} = 8$) and the power at $N = 70$. Participants are allocated to paths in the original fixed proportions.

			N for 80 percent power			
Design	c_{bm}	Slope (points per SD)	$t_{1/2} = 0$	0.2 week	1 week	Power at $N = 70$, 0.2 week
Hybrid	0.25	2.0	272	278	480	0.285
	0.35	2.8	138	140	244	0.503
	0.45	3.6	82	84	146	0.728
OL+BDC	0.25	2.0	394	404	> 800	0.210
	0.35	2.8	200	206	452	0.368
	0.45	3.6	120	124	272	0.558
Crossover	0.25	2.0	424	424	454	0.202
	0.35	2.8	216	216	230	0.353
	0.45	3.6	130	130	138	0.537

Appendix A. Closed-form derivations

A.5 The separable structure

The next table gives the contribution of each step between visits to the schedule term of the feasibility bound. The report carries it without a number.

Step	Term
on to on	$(1-\rho_t)/(1+\rho_t)$
on to off	$\rho_t^2/(1-\rho_t^2)$
off to on	$1/(1-\rho_t^2)$
off to off	0

Conclusions

The correlation encoding of the interaction is coherent. The original DGP holds the biomarker-response correlation constant after first exposure, so with any carryover the interaction is absent and power equals the test size. The extended DGP lets the correlation decay at the carryover half-life, and power returns to its no-carryover value at half-lives of 0.1 to 0.2 week. The original effect size of 0.6 relied on repaired matrices, and a separable AR(1) structure at serial correlation 0.7 raises the feasibility bound to 0.474. A prognostic biomarker with a pathway absent at baseline makes analyses that share the biomarker effect with baseline anticonservative. We propose the extended DGP, with a stop on infeasible matrices, as the reference for simulation studies of these designs.